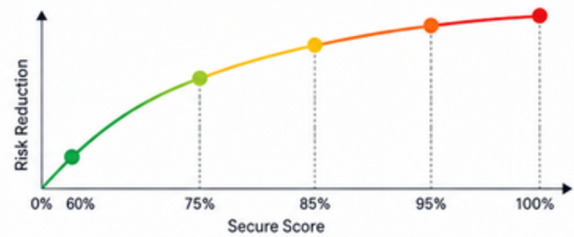




The Diminishing Returns Curve

Security improvement is not linear. The first 60 points of a Secure Score deliver enormous risk reduction. The next 15 deliver strong, sustainable improvement. From there, every additional point costs more than the one before it.



Score Range	Risk Reduction Curve	Friction Cost Curve
 0–60%	 Massive. Every point matters.	 Minimal. Most controls are invisible to users.
 60–75%	 Strong, sustainable risk reduction.	 Modest. Well-tolerated by users.
 75–85%	 Diminishing returns. Real but narrowing.	 Friction begins to grow faster than protection.
 85–95%	 Marginal protection gains.	 Significant operational drag.
 95–100%	 Theoretical only.	 Negative ROI in commercial environments.

Security Score: Why 100% Isn't the Goal

Security Isn't About Perfection

When someone asks, “**Why aren't we at 100%?**”, what they're really asking is: *Are we secure?*

The answer is more nuanced than a single percentage. Microsoft Secure Score measures enabled security controls — not overall operational effectiveness.

Secure Score is also influenced by Microsoft licensing tiers, meaning available controls and achievable scores can vary between organizations.

Every layer of security adds protection, but it can also add friction:

- More prompts
- More approvals
- More slowdowns

The goal is to create a secure environment your team can realistically work within every day.

➔ What Matters

0–60%

Easy to work, but high risk.

60–70%

Strong protection with minimal disruption.

70–80%

More control, but users start to feel it.

80%+

Security begins to slow the business down.

➔ The Takeaway

Security improvement is not linear.

The biggest gains happen early.

After about 70–75%, organizations often experience diminishing returns: less protection gain for significantly more friction.

For most businesses, the ideal range is:

65–75%

Strong. Defensible. Sustainable.